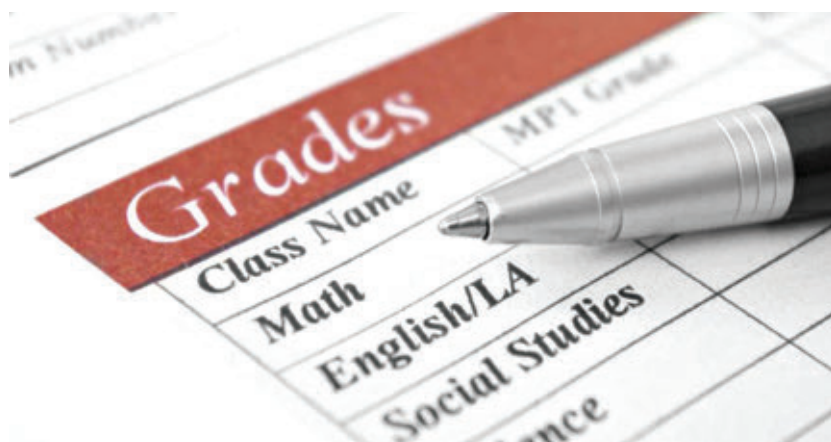




munity would like to have an intervention, if they can. This is where OpenAI's mysterious and secretive AI-generated text detection tool with an unheard of 99% accuracy rate starts to sound like the answer to all their prayers.

AI text detection explained

Before you know more about OpenAI's AI text detection tool, you need to understand how ChatGPT works in a nutshell. Based on its LLM training, ChatGPT generates text by predicting the most likely next word or word fragment in a sequence. For its AI text detection tool to work flawlessly every single time, OpenAI will subtly alter its text generation process, embedding a unique pattern or watermark within the generated text. While invisible to humans, this watermark can be detected by specialised software, allowing OpenAI to assess the likelihood that a given piece of text originated from ChatGPT or not.

According to OpenAI's internal data, this digital watermarking technique is highly effective when applied to sufficiently long text passages, as reported by the WSJ. OpenAI's Sam Altman has encouraged the development of the anti-cheat AI detection tool, company-wide sentiment seems to be that it would be challenging to determine who will eventually use this AI-generated text detection tool. It won't be useful if it isn't a mass-market product, but then that can also allow potential bad actors to crack the code behind the tool's watermarking process. And what about the impact on

ChatGPT subscribers and users, surely the market at large would frown upon the launch of any foolproof AI detection tool, I'd assume.

But clearly, that doesn't seem to be the case, as other big tech players are also attacking the opportunity of AI content detection tools. Earlier in 2023, OpenAI had launched AI classifier – it's first public product for detecting AI generated text content, which it swiftly shutdown for not being good enough. It correctly identified 26% of AI-written text as "likely AI-written," while incorrectly labelled human-written text as AI-written 9% of the time. Google's DeepMind has also announced a new watermarking method, called SynthID, which aims to help people identify AI-generated content by looking for embedded digital markers in AI-generated text or video. The tool is still in beta, and not yet ready for public release. Microsoft is focused on preventing harmful AI-content generation across its cloud-services in the form of Azure AI Content Safety – a system that monitors content generated by both foundational models and humans, filtering potential risky content or low-quality AI generation for its Azure customers.



Challenges in AI generated text detection

One of the reasons why AI generated text detection tools haven't passed muster is because of their low accuracy rate – as was the case with OpenAI's AI classifier, which got shut down fairly quickly. Another problem is this technology's potential to harm rather than help.

Incorrectly labelling human-written text as AI-written content is an inexcusable error, something that almost all of the AI cheating detection tools are guilty of to some degree or other. Which is why several major universities like Michigan State, Northwestern and the University of Texas at Austin, have pulled the plug on their AI detection software, according to a Bloomberg report. Just as well, the correct decision was taken in hindsight, because falsely accusing any student of using AI written content tools would be a huge blow to their academic career. Until the accuracy of these tools increases, their tendency to wrongly flag non-AI generated content improves, there's no silver bullet coming to the aid of the teaching community just yet.

We all were students once, right? The allure of shortcuts and the pressure to achieve high grades have always existed – will always exist going forward as well – for students here in India and elsewhere in the world. ChatGPT has merely provided a more sophisticated tool for students than before. I'd argue that the rampant use of AI by students to hoodwink their teachers is symptomatic of deeper educational challenges rather than some sort of collateral damage on the path of AI progress.

As far as OpenAI's hidden AI cheating tool detector, it remains to be seen whether it's seriously able to detect AI-written content with a 99.9% accuracy or if it's just a marketing gimmick. The fact that the ChatGPT maker hasn't released the tool yet, which has been in development and internal debate for two years, and ready for launch for at least one year, suggests the AI company's erring on the side of caution for a change. **[I]**